

the next year or two will be roughly equal to that over the prior years, which is a linear world view. That works for the early stage of change, but not when the exponential curve starts to bend like a hockey stick. Unfortunately, most investment portfolios are being managed with a linear world view, with indices that are pegged to the past guiding our future investments. Nothing could be more shortsighted or potentially dangerous in a time of exponential change.

The Internet has irrevocably changed the world, and it continues to do so as developers build on the platform of connection it creates. Thus far, the World Wide Web has been the greatest meta-application to leverage the underlying fiber of the Internet. The indexed web contains at least 4.73 billion pages, nearing the point where there will be one page for every human.¹

The beginning of the Internet is commonly associated with the 1990s, with Tim Berners-Lee stumbling upon the idea of the World Wide Web while trying to create an information management system for CERN, and Marc Andreessen developing the first widely used web browser, which ultimately became Netscape. Although the accomplishments of Berners-Lee and Andreessen were linchpins to mainstream adoption, the web and the ability to browse it were the first killer apps built on top of the Internet, not to be conflated with the creation of the Internet itself. We are likely still in the early stages of leveraging the potential of the Internet and building meta-applications atop it.